City & Guilds
A City & Guilds Group Business

www.cityandguilds.com
February 2021 version 0.1

Functional Skills Level 1 English Writing Sample Paper 4

Worked Example – good pass

OFFICIAL MFS MODEL SOLUTION · BENCHMARK EXEMPLARY PASS

Comprehensive Exemplars (Full Tutor Analysis & Mark Scheme Grids)

- Assessment: Sample Paper 4 (Exemplar Benchmarks: Good · Borderline · Fail)
- Subject: City & Guilds Functional Skills English Level 1 Writing (4748)
- Complete accredited step-by-step models and tutor guidance
- Exam Board: City & Guilds (Ofqual Regulated Reform Standard)

Verified by Tutor Abdul (Senior Assessor) · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

ONLINE LEARNING PLATFORM & ACCREDITED COURSES

Pearson Edexcel & Open Awards Accredited Suite · Entry 3, Level 1 & Level 2

Pass Your Functional Skills Exams With Confidence

100% Pass Guarantee | Dyslexia-Friendly Learning | 1-to-1 Expert Tutor Support

Master Functional Skills provides an adaptive, dyslexia-friendly online learning platform tailored for adult learners, apprentices, and NHS healthcare staff. Everything you need to revise, practice, and pass is at your fingertips.

1. Smart Diagnostic Initial Assessment

Calculate your exact working level and pinpoint knowledge gaps instantly

- **Exact Grade Calculation:** Adaptive assessments calculate your exact level across all topics.
- **Personalised Study Pathway:** Skip what you know; focus 100% on the topics needed to pass.
- **Real-Time Exam Readiness:** Predictive tracker confirms when you are 100% ready to book.

2. Comprehensive Video Lessons & Worked Solutions

Bite-sized visual explainers covering every single Maths & English curriculum standard

- **Step-by-Step Video Lessons:** Master percentages, algebra, perimeter, ratio, and reverse fractions.
- **Multi-Ink Handwriting Models:** Visual 3-colour methods showing working, carries, and examiner tips.
- **Tutor Shortcuts & Golden Rules:** Proven non-calculator mental arithmetic hacks and BIDMAS tricks.

3. Full Mock Exams & Real-Time Performance Analytics

Practice in exam conditions and watch your scores and confidence climb

- **Authentic Exam Papers:** Timed Section A & Section B papers formatted exactly like Pearson Edexcel.
- **Instant Topic Breakdown:** View percentage scores across Number, Measure/Shape, and Data.
- **Historical Score Tracking:** Monitor past attempts to ensure continuous improvement before exam day.

Ready to Master Your Functional Skills & Pass First Time?

Join thousands of healthcare staff, apprentices, and adult learners across the UK.

Instant 24/7 access on desktop, tablet, and mobile with no software to install.

START LEARNING TODAY AT

MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 1

You have to arrange an event and you would like your friend to help.

Your task: write an email to a friend to explain the type of event you want to hold and the role you would like them to have in organising it. Choose one of the following events:

a wedding reception
a charity fundraising day
a family sports day
a 21st birthday celebration.

Your email should explain the following:

- what type of event you are planning
- specific details about the event (eg, theme, timings, guest numbers, seating arrangements or anything else relevant to the event)
- your friend's role in helping to organise the event
- your friend's role on the day.

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

To:	JH@green.co.uk
Cc:	
Subject:	Cancer Research Fundraising

Hi Emily

Thanks for chatting to me about my idea. I am now putting a few ideas in writing so we can make a start with the planning. Thanks loads for agreeing to help out.

My idea is to climb up Heaton Hill just on my hands and knees! I have worked out it will probably take me 5 hours to do it like this. I know it's going to be really hard but hopefully it will help me raise more money. The good news is that there is grass all the way to the top so I won't have to crawl on any ground that is too hard.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Good Pass

I am planing to do it on May the 23rd so I would need to have every thing organised by then. It would be great if you could help me by writing a letter that we can send to as many local businesses as possible explaining what we are doing and asking them to sponsor us.

On the day I will need you to walk along beside me to make sure I am alright and to bring along spare knee pads, gloves, plasters and bandages and any refreshments I will need such as water and high energy snacks.

I know it's a bit of a crazy idea, but compaired to what people with cancer go through, its nothing. Thanks for helping me. Shall we meet up tomorrow to chat it though more?

Thanks

Debbie

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	15

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level** **4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time** **3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time** **2 marks**	**Limited accuracy** **1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence** **0 marks**	
Spelling	4					
Punctuation	4					
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						12
SPaG mark + composition mark						27

Commentary

Composition

Composition is strong. The information is communicated with clarity and coherence and contains an appropriate amount of detail. Format and structure are both strong: all the required elements of an email are present, the structure includes a sentence giving context to the email, followed by the detail, and there is an attempt to bring the email to a conclusion. Language is appropriate, including the times where more colloquial expressions are used, such as *thanks loads*, as the email is being sent to a friend.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is consistently strong, with only four errors. Punctuation is also strong as there are only one or two omitted commas and apostrophes. There is evidence of punctuation beyond simple sentence demarcation, including the use of commas to separate clauses. Grammar is accurate throughout.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 2

You work for a website that encourages young people to try new things.

Your task: write a set of instructions for the website covering one of the following topics:

how to cook your favourite dish
how to carve a Halloween pumpkin
how to maintain a bicycle/car/scooter
how to perform a trick on a skateboard
how to apply makeup
how to create a hairstyle
how to play a game.

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

Lasagne

This is an Italian dish that is so easy to make, really filling and guaranteed to be liked by almost everybody. It can be served with a side salad and garlic bread to make it even more authentic. There are vegan and vegetarian alternatives as well so everyone is happy!

Ingredients

9 lasagne sheets
750 grams of beef mince meat
1 onion
A tin of chopped tomatoes
Tomato puree
Packet of authentic Lasagne mix
Cheese sauce
Grated cheese

How to cook

Pre-heat the oven to 180 degrees.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Good Pass

Chop the onion into small pieces and put them in a saucepan on a medium heat. When they have turned soft add the mince and fry until it is brown.

Drain off the excess fat and add the tin of tomatoes and a tablespoon of tomato puree.

Mix the lasagne mix according to the instructions (usually just adding the mix to approximately a quarter pint of water) and add this to the mince, and then continue to heat on the hob for a further 5 minutes.

In the meantime make the cheese sauce. For simplicity, use a cheese sauce mix available from most supermarkets. Simply add the mix to half a pint of milk and bring to the boil on the hob, stirring continuously.

Once the cheese sauce is ready get a large baking dish and spoon a thin layer of the mince meat into the bottom. Cover this with three lasagne sheets and then add a layer of cheese sauce. Repeat this three times, finishing with a layer of cheese sauce and then sprinkle some grated cheese onto the top.

Bake the dish in the oven for 35-40 minutes or util the cheese is golden brown.

As an alternative, replace the mincemeat with aubergines or courgettes.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	15

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling	4					
Punctuation	4					
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						12
SPaG mark + composition mark						27

Overall mark for question 2	27
Overall mark for question 1	27
FINAL MARK	54

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Good Pass

Commentary

Composition

Composition is very strong. Format and structure are excellent, the detail is appropriate, the language choice is straight forward and the listing of ingredients followed by the instructions broken down into paragraphs all come together to create a clear and coherent response.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is consistently correct, with only one or two errors. There is good evidence of more ambitious words such as *lasagne, guaranteed* and *aubergines*, for example.

Punctuation is consistently correct, with only the occasional error.

Grammar is correct throughout.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 1

You have to arrange an event and you would like your friend to help.

Your task: write an email to a friend to explain the type of event you want to hold and the role you would like them to have in organising it. Choose one of the following events:

a wedding reception
a charity fundraising day
a family sports day
a 21st birthday celebration.

Your email should explain the following:

- what type of event you are planning
- specific details about the event (eg, theme, timings, guest numbers, seating arrangements or anything else relevant to the event)
- your friend's role in helping to organise the event
- your friend's role on the day.

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

To:	FredG@btinternet.co.uk
Cc:	
Subject:	

Hi Fred

How are you doing.

As you know I have to organising Billys 21st birthday and I was hopping you could have help me abit. I am thinking we could start day with the breakfast at full monty cafe on Bridge street where all the guys could meet up at 8.30. Once we finished breakfast we could travel up the road to go-karting place. We could have hour or two there and then go to golf driving range and have near 100 balls. They have bar there as well so we can all have drink after. It will have been lunchtime then so we will need to eat somewhere and thats when I need your help. Can you have look to see where is

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

somewhere good to eat quite close to golf range. I am hoping there will be 12 of us so it needs to be quite big place. You need to reserve place for 1.00 oclock and to save time it would be good to have look at the menu before hand. Can you get menu and then ask everyones orders for the main meals. We need to finished lunch by 3 oclock because the match kicks of at 4.45 and we need to get to ground by 4.30 at the latest. What a day! Billy hasnt got clue.

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately		✓			
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing			✓		
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language			✓		
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	8

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling	4					
Punctuation				1		
Grammar				1		
SPaG Total						6
SPaG mark + composition mark						14

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Commentary

Composition

Despite some language difficulties, the information presented is clear and coherent most of the time. Most of the required detail is present, although there is no mention of the date of the event, nor the specific role of the friend on the day. In terms of format, the subject, valediction and name have been omitted. There is a mix of complex, compound and simple sentences, but punctuation is not controlled to form accurate sentences, and the language choice is often typical of a person for whom English may not be the first language.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is strong, with very few errors, but both punctuation and grammar errors are frequent. Most sentences contain at least one grammar error, and punctuation is limited to sentence demarcation only, with question marks, commas and apostrophes having been omitted.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 2

You work for a website that encourages young people to try new things.

Your task: write a set of instructions for the website covering one of the following topics:

how to cook your favourite dish
how to carve a Halloween pumpkin
how to maintain a bicycle/car/scooter
how to perform a trick on a skateboard
how to apply makeup
how to create a hairstyle
how to play a game.

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

My favourite dish - Pireogis

My favourite dish is from my home country and it is simple meal that fills stomach so you do not need to eat more. It is called Pireogis and is similar to english dumplings. Is important that everyone try these dish atleast once in lifetime to experience real Polish food.

Ingredients

For dumplings is simply mix self-raising flour, salt, vegetables oil and warm water in bowl and then make in to flat pieces.

Then is up to you what you put in dumplings. Is common in Poland to have mushroom, potato and cream. Is important to cook first the mushrooms and potato. When they are cooked you can wrap them in dumplings and then make sure they are closed into little parcel and then you put into boiling water for only 3-4 minute.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Service

You can serve them with another dish like salad or use dip such as sour cream. Lovely.

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately		✓			
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing		✓			
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language			✓		
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	10

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling	4					
Punctuation		3				
Grammar			2			
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						19

Overall mark for question 2	14
Overall mark for question 1	19
FINAL MARK	33

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Commentary

Composition

Most of the detail is present, but it would be usual in a recipe to talk about the quantities of each item needed. Whilst it is relatively short, it is an appropriate length for the subject matter and the audience. There has been an attempt to lay out the instructions under appropriate subheadings, but the ease of reading would have been aided by further breaking down the writing into smaller steps. What is written is clear and coherent, and the inclusion of an introduction and a conclusion aid with the coherence. Some of the language is typical of a person for whom English is not the first language, containing some clumsy and/or incorrect expressions.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is strong. There are very few errors and evidence of more ambitious words, such as *stomach* and *self-raising*.

Punctuation is also relatively strong. There are some errors, for instance omitting a capital letter on *English*, but the candidate demonstrates sound control of sentence demarcation and there is good evidence of using commas to separate items in a list.

Grammar errors are frequent and include omitted articles and pronouns, some subject-verb disagreement and singular words that should be plural.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example - Fail

Question 1

You have to arrange an event and you would like your friend to help.

Your task: write an email to a friend to explain the type of event you want to hold and the role you would like them to have in organising it. Choose one of the following events:

a wedding reception
a charity fundraising day
a family sports day
a 21st birthday celebration.

Your email should explain the following:

- what type of event you are planning
- specific details about the event (eg, theme, timings, guest numbers, seating arrangements or anything else relevant to the event)
- your friend's role in helping to organise the event
- your friend's role on the day.

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

To:	
Cc:	
Subject:	
I need you help with jos birth day celebration . We was gonna go to paint balling in weaver forest and I need yous to ask all the lads if they r gonna come and if they no how to get there. May be we need to ask if any one need a lift. Can you drive on the day. Cheers	

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example - Fail

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately				✓	
Writes text of appropriate detail and length				✓	
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language				✓	
Overall band	Band 1				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	3

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar				1		
SPaG Total						3
SPaG mark + composition mark						6

Commentary

Composition

The question directs the candidate to write between 200 and 300 words. The response above is significantly shorter and this is taken into account when allocating marks. Detail is very sparse, and the format and structuring elements are limited to a valediction only. The language is very informal as it is an email to a friend, but the use of *gonna*, *r* and *yous* are not appropriate for this formal examination.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Although there are only 2 spelling errors, the response is so short it is hard for an examiner to gain any levels of confidence about the candidate's spelling abilities, so a low mark is inevitable. It is a similar situation with both grammar and punctuation.

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example - Fail

Question 2

You work for a website that encourages young people to try new things.

Your task: write a set of instructions for the website covering one of the following topics:

how to cook your favourite dish
how to carve a Halloween pumpkin
how to maintain a bicycle/car/scooter
how to perform a trick on a skateboard
how to apply makeup
how to create a hairstyle
how to play a game.

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

Get two teams and one team starts on one side of the pich and the other team starts on the other side of the pich and a ball isn placed in the middle and one team starts the game and they has to try to get the ball into the other teams net and the other team has to get the ball in to the other teams net and the team that does this the most is the winner. If the ball goes out then the team who didnt put it out has to throw it in again and you are not alloud to touch the ball with your hands.

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately				✓	
Writes text of appropriate detail and length				✓	
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language				✓	
Overall band	Band 1				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	2

Sample Paper 4 Level 1 Worked Example - Fail

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar			2			
SPaG Total						4
SPaG mark + composition mark						6

Overall mark for question 2	6
Overall mark for question 1	6
FINAL MARK	12

Commentary

Composition

Once again, the response is very short, and this is taken into account when allocating marks. The brevity and the lack of detail contribute to a lack of clarity and coherence as it is not possible to be sure which game the candidate is attempting to explain. There has been no attempt to aid the reader through the use of format, structure and paragraphing, or through making use of short sentences as befits a set of instructions.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

There are some spelling errors and very few ambitious words. The relative brevity is also taken into account. Punctuation evidence is limited to sentence demarcation only. Grammar is mainly correct, but the brevity is once again taken into account.

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS STORE

OFFICIAL REVISION GUIDES, WORKBOOKS & FLASHCARDS

Written by accredited specialist tutors to match the exact 2026 Pearson Edexcel standards

Everything You Need To Revise, Practice & Pass Your English Level 1 Writing Exam



Core Writing Manual

English Level 1: Writing
Core Revision Guide

- All Edexcel formats (letters, reports)
- High-scoring Task 1 & Task 2 models
- Persuasive & organisational devices
- Dyslexia-friendly visual format

Spiral Bound Print & PDF

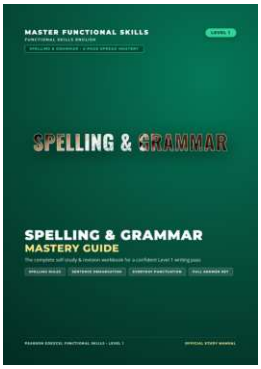


Guided Writing Drills

English Level 1: Writing
Companion Workbook

- 50+ realistic exam writing prompts
- Step-by-step planning templates
- Word-count & paragraphing builders
- Full Band 3 model answer keys

Spiral Bound Print & PDF



Full Grid B SPaG Marks

English Level 1: SPaG
Spelling & Grammar Mastery

- Master colons, semicolons & commas
- Complex sentences & tense control
- High-frequency exam spelling drills
- Secure 100% of Grid B SPaG marks

Spiral Bound Print & PDF



Pocket Flashcards A6

English Level 1
Pocket Revision Cards

- Compact A6 cards for quick study
- Format checklists for all text types
- Dual-sided rules & model examples
- Essential punctuation & DAFOREST tips

Boxed Card Deck & Print PDF

Order Official Study Guides & Revision Cards Online

Free Next-Day UK Tracked Shipping · Instant PDF Downloads Included

Trusted by NHS trusts, apprentices & adult learners nationwide.

VISIT THE ONLINE STORE

MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk